Warranty and Repair Service Manual

Gadget Grove Customer Support Knowledge Base

Field	Value
Document ID	KB-WAR-001
Version	4.0 (supersedes 3.4)
Effective date	October 1, 2026
Owner	Product Support and Service Operations
Audience	Tier 1 and Tier 2 support agents, Service Center staff, Technical Services Managers
Related documents	Shipping and Delivery Guide (KB-SHP-001); Subscription Billing Handbook (KB-BIL-001); Return, Refund and Exchange Policy (KB-RET-001)

Contents

1. **Introduction**
2. **Warranty Coverage**
3. **Gadget Grove Care Protection Plan**
4. **Making a Warranty Claim**
5. **Service Options**
6. **Out-of-Warranty Repairs**
7. **Troubleshooting Before a Claim**
8. **Agent Guidance**
9. **Regional Notes**
10. **Frequently Asked Questions**
11. **Contact Information**

Appendix A. Worked Claim Examples

Appendix B. Identifier Formats

Appendix C. Revision History

> **Note.** Coverage depends on three things: the product category, the country of purchase and whether the customer has a Gadget Grove Care plan. Always confirm all three before quoting a decision. Rule conflicts are resolved with Section 1.5.

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This manual describes the warranty coverage on Gadget Grove-branded and Gadget Grove-sold products, how customers can request a repair or replacement, what is and is not covered, and how agents should handle claims. It also describes the optional Gadget Grove Care protection plan.

1.2 Scope

1.2.1 Products Covered

This manual applies to electronics and appliances sold by Gadget Grove and fulfilled by Gadget Grove.

1.2.2 Products Not Covered

- Products sold by marketplace sellers: the seller's warranty applies.
- Returns within the return window: covered by the Return, Refund and Exchange Policy.
- Shipping problems, such as a package damaged in transit
    - Follow Section 8.4 of the Shipping and Delivery Guide of the shipping guide if the customer reports damage within the first days after delivery.
    - If the device fails later without visible damage, follow this manual.

1.3 Warranty Versus Manufacturer Warranty

Gadget Grove-branded products carry a Gadget Grove Limited Warranty. Products from other brands include the manufacturer's warranty. Gadget Grove handles the first line of support, but repair terms for third-party brands are set by the manufacturer.

1.3.1 Gadget Grove-Branded Products

The Gadget Grove Limited Warranty applies, with the periods in Section 2.1. Claims are handled by Gadget Grove from start to finish.

1.3.2 Third-Party Brands

1.3.2.1 Within 90 Days of Delivery

For these items, Gadget Grove will help customers start a claim with the manufacturer or, if the product is within 90 days of delivery, replace the product directly.

1.3.2.1.1 Replacement Conditions

- The product must have a hardware defect confirmed by troubleshooting (Section 7).
- The customer must return the defective unit using the prepaid label within 14 days.
- Replacement is of the **same model**. If it is not in stock, the customer chooses an equivalent or a refund.

1.3.2.2 After 90 Days

The customer is directed to the manufacturer. The agent provides the manufacturer's warranty contact, the order number and the serial number. If the manufacturer's warranty is shorter than the Gadget Grove periods in Section 2.1, **the manufacturer's warranty governs** for third-party brands.

> **Exception.** Third-party products covered by a Gadget Grove Care plan are repaired under the Care plan even after the 90-day period. See Section 3.

1.4 Definitions

Table 1.1 — Defined terms

Term	Meaning
Defect	A failure caused by materials, workmanship, or factory-installed firmware, occurring under normal use.
Accidental damage	Sudden, unintended physical damage such as drops, spills or crushing.
Claim	A request registered in the claims system with a claim number (format WC-XXXXXXXX).
Warranty start date	The delivery date shown on the order or the date of in-store purchase.
Service Center	Gadget Grove Service Center, Austin, TX, or an authorized partner.
Care plan	Gadget Grove Care protection plan.
Known Issues board	Internal list of product-specific problems and recalls maintained by Product Safety.
Out of service	A day on which the customer does not have a working product because it is with the Service Center or awaiting parts.

1.5 Precedence of Rules

1. A **safety recall** or safety procedure (for example, Section 8.5).
2. **Statutory consumer rights** of the customer's country or state (Section 9).
3. The **Lemon Policy** (Section 8.7).
4. The **Care plan** terms (Section 3), when the customer has one.
5. The **standard warranty** in Section 2.
6. **Goodwill exceptions** (Section 8.3).

2. Warranty Coverage

2.1 Warranty Periods

Table 2.1 — Warranty periods by product category

Product Category	Gadget Grove Limited Warranty	Extended with Gadget Grove Care
Mobile and wearable		
Smartphones and tablets	12 months	Up to 36 months
Smartwatches and wearables	12 months	Up to 36 months

Product Category	Gadget Grove Limited Warranty	Extended with Gadget Grove Care
Headphones, earbuds and speakers	12 months	Up to 36 months
Computing and display		
Laptops and computers	24 months	Up to 48 months
Televisions and monitors	24 months	Up to 60 months
Home		
Small kitchen appliances	24 months	Up to 48 months
Large appliances	24 months, parts and labor	Up to 60 months
Imaging and other		
Cameras and drones	12 months	Up to 36 months
Accessories and cables	6 months	Not available
Batteries (included with product)	12 months, see Section 2.4	Up to 24 months

The warranty begins on the delivery date shown on the order or the date of in-store purchase.

2.1.1 When the Warranty Start Date Changes

2.1.1.1 Orders With Several Deliveries

For orders that ship in several packages, the start date is the delivery date of the **package containing the product**.

2.1.1.2 Replacement Units

A replacement unit is covered for the remainder of the original warranty or 90 days, whichever is longer (see Section 5.5.1). The warranty start date of the original product does not change.

2.1.1.3 Gifts

For gifts, the start date is the delivery date. If the gift was bought in store, the start date is the in-store purchase date shown on the gift receipt.

2.2 What Is Covered

The warranty covers defects in materials and workmanship that occur under normal use. This includes:

2.2.1 Hardware Failures

- A device that will not turn on, charge, or connect.
- Defective buttons, ports, speakers, microphones, cameras and sensors.

2.2.2 Screen Defects

Screen defects such as dead pixels, discoloration, or touch failures that are not caused by impact.

2.2.2.1 Dead Pixel Thresholds

Table 2.2 — Dead pixel thresholds

Screen type	Covered if	Not covered if
Phones, tablets, watches	3 or more dead pixels in a cluster, or any dead pixel in the center area	Fewer than 3 dead pixels outside the center area
Laptops and monitors up to 27 inches	3 or more dead pixels in a cluster, or 5 or more anywhere	Fewer than 5 isolated dead pixels
Televisions over 27 inches	Any cluster of 3 or more, or 8 or more anywhere	Fewer than 8 isolated dead pixels

2.2.2.1.1 Center Area Definition

2.2.2.1.1.1 Phones and Tablets

The center area is the middle 50% of the screen width and height.

2.2.2.1.1.2 Watches

The center area is the middle 60% of the display width and height, because the display is smaller.

2.2.2.2 Other Screen Defects

- Discoloration, lines, or flickering without any sign of impact: covered.
- Touch failure with a cracked screen: **not** covered (accidental damage, Section 2.3.1).
- Burn-in on OLED screens: covered only if it appears within the first 6 months and the device was not used with a static image for more than 24 hours.

2.2.3 Firmware and Included Accessories

- Faults caused by factory-installed firmware.
- Defective power adapters and cables included in the box.
- Battery capacity degradation below the stated threshold (Section 2.4).

2.3 What Is Not Covered

The warranty does not cover:

2.3.1 Accidental Damage

Accidental damage, such as drops, cracked screens or crushed housings. This damage is covered by Gadget Grove Care (Section 3.1.1).

2.3.2 Liquid Damage and Environment

2.3.2.1 General Rule

Liquid damage or exposure to extreme humidity, dust or heat is not covered.

2.3.2.2 Liquid Contact Indicators

- If the liquid contact indicator (LCI) is **red**, treat the device as liquid-damaged. See Section 8.2.
- If the product is rated for water resistance (for example, IP68)
  - The rating covers **new** devices only. Seals degrade over time.
  - If the device failed within the first 12 months and the LCI is red:

- The claim is declined under the standard warranty.
- If the customer has Care, it is covered as accidental damage subject to the deductible.

2.3.3 Unauthorized Repairs and Modifications

Unauthorized repairs, modifications or opening of the device are not covered. Self-repair with genuine parts through the Repair Hub does not void the warranty on its own (Section 6.4.1).

2.3.4 Cosmetic Wear

Cosmetic wear, including scratches, dents, fading and discoloration, is not covered.

2.3.5 Other Exclusions

- Loss or theft.
- Damage caused by non-certified accessories, chargers or power surges.
- Software problems caused by third-party apps, malware, or unauthorized operating system changes.
- Consumable parts, such as ear tips, filters and brushes.
- Products with removed or altered serial numbers.
- Commercial or industrial use of consumer products.
- Damage caused by improper installation or by failing to follow the user manual.

2.4 Battery Coverage

Batteries are covered when their maximum capacity falls below 80% of the original capacity within 12 months of delivery, or within 500 full charge cycles, whichever occurs first.

2.4.1 Cycle Limits by Product

Table 2.3 — Battery thresholds

Product	Capacity threshold	Cycle limit	Time limit
Smartphones and tablets	Below 80%	500 cycles	12 months
Laptops	Below 80%	1,000 cycles	24 months
Earbuds and headphones	Below 70%	400 cycles	12 months
Smartwatches	Below 80%	500 cycles	12 months
Cameras and drones	Below 75%	300 cycles	12 months

> **Note.** The 500-cycle and 80% figures in the introduction to this section are the **default**. Product-specific values in Table 2.3 override the default.

2.4.2 Checking Battery Health

Battery health is checked in device settings or using the Gadget Grove diagnostic tool.

2.4.3 Battery Swelling

Battery swelling is always covered if the device is within the warranty and shows no sign of misuse. Swollen batteries are a safety issue; customers should stop using the device immediately and agents should follow the Battery Safety Procedure in Section 8.5.

2.5 Proof of Purchase and Registration

Warranty status is checked automatically using the serial number and order record. Customers do not have to register. If the product was a gift or purchased in store, a gift receipt, a store receipt, or the product serial number is sufficient. Registering a product in the Gadget Grove app adds it to the customer's "My Devices" list for easier future claims.

2.6 Transferability

The warranty transfers to a new owner for the remainder of the period when the product is resold, if the serial number and proof of purchase are available. Gadget Grove Care plans are not transferable.

3. Gadget Grove Care Protection Plan

3.1 What It Includes

Gadget Grove Care extends the warranty and adds accidental damage coverage. It can be added at checkout or within 60 days of delivery.

Table 3.1 — Standard warranty versus Care

Feature	Standard Warranty	Gadget Grove Care
Manufacturing defects	Yes	Yes
Accidental damage (drops, spills)	No	Yes, subject to the limit
Battery replacement	Under 80% in 12 months	Under 80% for the full term
Power surge	No	Yes
Theft and loss	No	Not covered
Coverage limit	n/a	Purchase price per claim
Claims per year	Unlimited	2 accidental damage claims per 12 months
Deductible	None	$29 to $99, by product

3.1.1 Accidental Damage Coverage

3.1.1.1 What Counts as Accidental Damage

- Drops, cracked screens, and crushed housings.
- Liquid spills and immersion, including cases where the liquid contact indicator is red.
- Damage from a power surge
  - The customer must provide a description of the event.
  - A surge protector is not required.

3.1.1.2 Limits

1. Up to 2 accidental damage claims per 12 months. The 12 months are counted from the date of the first claim.
2. Each claim is limited to the purchase price of the product.

3. A deductible is charged for each accidental damage claim, by product:
    a. The deductible is collected before the repair starts (mail-in) or at drop-off (in-store).
    b. If the claim is later found to be a manufacturing defect, the deductible is refunded.

3.1.1.2.1 Counting the Two Claims

3.1.1.2.1.1 What Counts as a Claim

A claim counts when it is **approved** as accidental damage. Declined and withdrawn claims do not count.

3.1.1.2.1.2 Claims Closed as Defects

If a claim is first filed as accidental damage but the reviewer finds a manufacturing defect, it is reclassified, the deductible is refunded, and it does **not** count toward the limit of 2.

3.1.1.3 Deductibles by Product

Table 3.2 — Deductibles

Product	Deductible
Headphones and earbuds	$29
Smartwatches and wearables	$39
Tablets	$49
Smartphones	$69
Televisions and monitors	$79
Laptops	$99

3.1.2 Battery Coverage Under Care

Care replaces the battery if capacity falls under 80% at any point in the plan term, regardless of the cycle limit in Section 2.4.1.

3.2 Pricing

Prices depend on the product and term. Examples at the time of publication:

Table 3.3 — Care plan prices

Product	2 Years	3 Years
Smartphone (up to $800)	$79	$119
Laptop (up to $1,500)	$149	$219
Tablet	$59	$89
Headphones	$29	$45
Television (up to $1,000)	$99	$149

3.3 Cancelling Gadget Grove Care

Care plans can be cancelled at any time. A full refund is given within 30 days of purchase if no claims were made. After 30 days, a prorated refund is given based on the remaining term, less any claims paid.

3.3.1 Refund Calculation

Refund = plan price × (remaining months ÷ total months) − claims paid. The refund cannot be less than zero.

> **Example.** A 3-year smartphone plan costs $119 and is cancelled after 12 months with one paid claim of $120. Remaining months = 24 of 36. Prorated amount = $119 × 24 ÷ 36 = $79.33. Less claims paid ($120) the result is below zero, so the refund is $0.

3.3.2 Billing Questions

Care plan payments and installments are explained in Section 7.4 of the Subscription Billing Handbook. Gadget Grove Plus billing agents do not process Care refunds.

3.4 Which Coverage Applies First

1. If the problem is a defect and the product is inside the standard warranty, use the **standard warranty**. No deductible applies.
2. If the problem is accidental damage, use **Care**. A deductible applies.
3. If the standard warranty has ended but Care has not, treat defects under **Care** with no deductible.
4. If the cause is unclear, create the claim as a defect and let the reviewer decide (Section 4.3). The deductible is not charged until the reviewer classifies the claim as accidental damage.

4. Making a Warranty Claim

4.1 Before You Submit a Claim

Customers are advised to:

- Back up data. Gadget Grove is not responsible for data loss during repair.
- Sign out of personal accounts and turn off device-locking features such as Find My Device.
- Remove SIM cards, memory cards, cases, screen protectors and accessories.
- Try the basic troubleshooting steps in Section 7.

4.2 How to Submit a Claim

1. Sign in and open My Orders or My Devices.
2. Select the product and choose Start a warranty claim.
3. Describe the problem and answer the questions on screen.
4. Upload photos or a short video showing the problem and the serial number.
5. Choose a service option (Section 5).
6. A claim number (format WC-XXXXXXXX) is issued within a few minutes.

4.2.1 Claims by Phone or Chat

Claims can also be made by phone or chat. Agents must verify the customer’s identity at Level 1 (see the Account and Security Help Center).

4.3 Claim Review

Claims are reviewed within 1 business day. The reviewer checks the warranty period, the serial number, the photos, and the description. Outcomes are:

Table 4.1 — Claim outcomes

Outcome	Next Step
Approved	Customer chooses a service option
More information needed	Customer is asked for further photos or tests
Troubleshooting needed	A support agent contacts the customer
Declined	The reason is explained; out-of-warranty repair may be offered

4.3.1 Review Time by Situation

Table 4.2 — Review targets

Claim type	Review target
Standard defect, complete information	1 business day
Missing photos or serial number	Clock stops until the customer replies; 7 days to reply, then the claim is closed
Safety claim (SAFETY-BATT tag)	Same business day
Repeat claim (third repair for the same fault)	2 business days; Technical Services Manager

4.4 Disputing a Declined Claim

If a claim is declined, the customer can request a second review within 30 days by replying to the decision email with extra information. A different reviewer will examine the claim. Agents may escalate to Tier 2 at the customer's request.

4.4.1 What to Tell the Customer

- The second review is final for the standard warranty process.
- The customer's statutory rights (Section 9) are not affected by the decision.

5. Service Options

5.1 Mail-In Repair

The customer is sent a prepaid shipping label and a protective box (for devices over $200). The device is shipped to a Gadget Grove Service Center, inspected, repaired and shipped back.

5.1.1 Turnaround

Typical turnaround is 7 to 10 business days from receipt, including shipping. Complex repairs can take up to 21 days.

5.1.2 Packaging

- The customer does not need the original box.
- If the customer ships in their own box
  - the prepaid label can still be used, and
  - damage caused by inadequate packaging may not be covered.
- Devices with a swollen battery **must not** be sent in the standard kit; see Section 8.5.

5.2 Advance Replacement

For approved claims on smartphones, tablets, laptops and headphones, Gadget Grove can ship a replacement unit before the defective unit is returned.

5.2.1 Eligibility

- Gadget Grove Plus members and Gadget Grove Care customers.
- Limited to the United States.
- Smartphones, tablets, laptops and headphones only.

5.2.2 Card Hold

A hold of the product price is placed on the customer's card and released when the defective unit is received within 14 days. If the original device is not received within 14 days, the hold is captured.

5.2.2.1 How the Hold Is Handled

1. The hold is placed when the replacement ships.
2. The 14 days are counted from the date the replacement is **delivered**.
3. The hold is released when:
   a. the defective unit is scanned as received at the Service Center, **and**
   b. inspection shows it is the unit registered under the claim (serial number match).
4. If the serial number does not match, the hold is captured and a fraud review starts.

5.2.2.1.1 If the Unit Is Lost in Transit

5.2.2.1.1.1 Carrier Proof of Delivery

If the carrier shows the return package as delivered to the Service Center but it cannot be located, the hold is released and the case goes to the Service Center manager.

5.2.2.1.1.2 Customer-Caused Loss

If the customer never shipped the unit, or shipped it after the 14 days, the hold is captured. The customer may appeal within 30 days by sending proof of shipment.

5.2.2.2 Card Hold for Plus Members

> **Exception.** Plus members who also have Care are not charged a hold. The hold applies to all other eligible customers.

5.3 In-Store Service

Customers can bring the device to any Gadget Grove store with a Service Desk. Simple repairs, such as battery and screen replacements, are normally completed in 1 to 3 hours. Customers may book an appointment in the app. The wait for other repairs is typically 3 to 5 business days.

5.4 On-Site Service for Large Appliances

Large appliances and televisions over 55 inches are repaired at the customer's home by an authorized technician. The technician calls within 2 business days to schedule a visit in a 4-hour window. Parts that are not on the vehicle may require a second visit.

5.4.1 Customer Requirements

- An adult must be present.
- Access to the appliance and utility connections.
- A clear working space around the appliance.

5.4.2 Delivery of a Replacement Large Appliance

If a replacement is approved, delivery follows the white-glove options in Section 10.2.3 of the Shipping and Delivery Guide, with the haul-away of the old unit included at no charge.

5.5 Repair Versus Replacement

Gadget Grove may choose to repair or replace a product. If a repair is not possible or economical, the product will be replaced with the same model or an equivalent.

5.5.1 Replacement Units

Replacement units may be new or certified refurbished, and are covered for the remainder of the original warranty or 90 days, whichever is longer.

5.5.2 When No Equivalent Is Available

If no equivalent is available, a refund of the purchase price (less any discounts for use if the product is beyond 12 months) will be issued as store credit or to the original payment method.

5.5.2.1 Discount for Use

Discount for use = purchase price × 2% × the number of full months after month 12, up to a maximum of 40% of the purchase price.

> **Example.** A smartphone was bought for $800 and has no equivalent replacement. The claim is approved in month 18. Full months after month 12 = 6. Discount = $800 × 2% × 6 = $96. Refund = $704. Under Care, no discount for use applies.

5.6 Data and Privacy During Repair

Technicians do not need access to personal data. Devices should be wiped before shipment where possible. If the device cannot be wiped, repairs will be done in a secure area and customer data will not be accessed or copied. Service centers are audited yearly. Devices that are replaced are erased before being refurbished or recycled.

6. Out-of-Warranty Repairs

6.1 How It Works

Products outside the warranty period, or damage that is not covered, can still be repaired for a fee. A quote is given after diagnosis. The customer can accept or decline. If declined, the device is returned and a diagnostic fee applies.

6.2 Typical Prices

Table 6.1 — Out-of-warranty repair prices

Repair	Estimated Price
Smartphones and tablets	
Smartphone screen replacement	$89 to $279
Smartphone battery replacement	$49 to $89
Tablet screen replacement	$119 to $249
Laptops	
Laptop battery replacement	$99 to $179
Laptop keyboard or trackpad	$129 to $249
Laptop screen replacement	$199 to $399
Audio and diagnostics	
Headphone battery replacement	$39 to $79
Water damage diagnostic	$29 (non-refundable)
Diagnostic fee (declined quote)	$15

Prices are estimates and vary by model. The final quote is shown in the app and by email.

6.2.1 Which Diagnostic Fee Applies

- **$15:** the customer declines a quote after a regular diagnosis.
- **$29, non-refundable:** a water damage diagnostic. Applies even if the customer accepts the repair; the $29 is **not** deducted from the repair price.

6.3 Repair Warranty

Repairs done by Gadget Grove carry a 90-day warranty on the repaired part and on the work done.

6.4 Parts Availability

Gadget Grove supports products with parts and service for at least 5 years after the product is discontinued.

6.4.1 Repair Hub

Genuine parts and repair guides are available on the Gadget Grove Repair Hub for customers who prefer to repair devices themselves. Using the Repair Hub does not void the warranty if the repair is done with genuine parts and the manual is followed, but damage caused during the repair is not covered.

6.4.2 Regional Parts Requirements

California customers are entitled to repair parts for 7 years for products over $100 (see Section 9.1).

7. Troubleshooting Before a Claim

7.1 Smartphones and Tablets

7.1.1 Power and Charging

Table 7.1 — Phone and tablet power and charging

Symptom	Try This
Will not turn on	Charge for 30 minutes with the original cable. Hold the power and volume-down buttons for 15 seconds.
Will not charge	Clean the charging port with a dry wooden toothpick. Try a different cable and adapter.
Frozen screen	Force restart by holding the power and volume-up buttons for 10 seconds.
Battery drains fast	Check Settings > Battery for apps with high usage. Update the operating system.

7.1.1.1 Extended Procedure for “Will Not Charge”

1. Try a different outlet and a different cable.
2. Inspect the port:
    a. Use a flashlight. Look for lint or debris.
    b. If debris is visible:
        i. Power the device off.
        ii. Use a dry wooden or plastic toothpick. **Never use metal.**
    c. If the port looks bent or burnt, stop. This indicates damage; see Section 8.2.
3. Test with a wireless charger if the device supports it.
4. If none of these work, create a claim.

7.1.2 Connectivity and Touch

Table 7.2 — Phone and tablet connectivity and touch

Symptom	Try This
No cellular signal	Remove and reinsert the SIM card. Toggle airplane mode. Reset network settings.
Touch not working	Remove screen protector. Restart the device. Boot into safe mode.

7.2 Laptops

Table 7.3 — Laptops

Symptom	Try This
Will not boot	Disconnect all accessories. Hold the power button for 30 seconds. Connect to power and retry.
Overheating or loud fan	Use on a hard surface. Clean vents. Update BIOS and drivers.
Wi-Fi drops	Update drivers. Forget and rejoin the network. Test on another network.
Battery not charging	Test a different charger. Check battery health in the diagnostic tool.
Black screen	Connect an external monitor. Press Windows + Ctrl + Shift + B (Windows).
Keyboard keys not working	Restart. Update drivers. Test in BIOS.

7.3 Headphones and Speakers

Table 7.4 — Headphones and speakers

Symptom	Try This
One earbud not working	Reset by placing both in the case for 10 seconds, then pair again.
Will not pair	Forget the device on your phone. Hold the pairing button until the light flashes.
Low volume or muffled sound	Clean ear tips and mesh. Replace ear tips.
Case not charging	Clean the contacts. Try another cable.
Crackling sound	Update firmware. Move away from sources of interference.

7.4 Small Appliances

Table 7.5 — Small appliances

Symptom	Try This
Will not turn on	Check the outlet and the fuse. Make sure the lid or jar is locked.
Overheating	Let cool for 30 minutes. Make sure vents are clear.
Unusual noise	Stop use. Check for loose parts or blockages.
Not heating	Descale if the appliance uses water. Check for error codes in the manual.

7.5 Resets

If a device is still not working after troubleshooting, a factory reset can be tried. Customers must back up data first. Agents should confirm the customer has done this before recommending a reset.

7.5.1 Reset Confirmation Script

1. Ask: “Have you backed up your photos, contacts and files?”
2. If the answer is no:
    a. Do not recommend the reset.
    b. Create the claim and continue; the Service Center will not need a reset.
3. If yes, walk the customer through the reset and record that the confirmation was given.

8. Agent Guidance

8.1 Handling Claims

1. Verify the customer at Level 1.
2. Look up the product by serial number or order.
3. Confirm warranty status in the system.
4. Ask for a description and a photo or video.
5. Walk through the matching troubleshooting steps in Section 7.
6. If unresolved, create the claim and explain the service options.
7. Tell the customer what to expect: timeline, label, data backup.

8.2 Deciding Whether Damage Is Covered

Table 8.1 — Coverage decisions

Evidence	Likely Decision
Cracked screen with impact marks	Not covered (accidental damage)
Vertical lines on screen with no external damage	Covered
Liquid contact indicator is red	Not covered
Swollen battery	Covered if device shows no misuse
Dents or bent frame	Not covered
Device will not power on, no visible damage	Covered
Software crash after a third-party app	Troubleshoot; not covered if app is the cause

Agents should be polite and neutral when a claim is declined and always offer an out-of-warranty option.

8.2.1 How the Table Interacts With Care

The table above describes the **standard warranty**. For customers with Care, anything marked “Not covered (accidental damage)” becomes covered, subject to the deductible in Section 3.1.1.3. Theft and loss are never covered, even under Care.

8.3 Goodwill Exceptions

8.3.1 Agent Authority

Agents may extend goodwill up to 30 days after warranty expiry for products with a known defect in the first year.

8.3.2 Team Lead Authority

Team leads may approve up to 90 days and a discount of up to 50% on an out-of-warranty repair.

8.3.3 Record Keeping

Goodwill must be recorded in the case notes.

8.4 Known Defects and Recalls

Check the Known Issues board for product-specific problems and recalls. If a product is subject to a recall, offer the recall remedy regardless of warranty status. Recall details are posted at gadgetgrove.example/recalls.

8.5 Battery Safety Procedure

If a customer reports a swollen, hot or smoking battery:

1. Ask the customer to stop using and unplug the device immediately.
2. Tell them to place it on a non-flammable surface away from anything flammable.
3. Do not put it in a bag or ship it by regular mail.
4. Create a priority claim with the tag SAFETY-BATT.
    a. This claim is reviewed on the same business day.
    b. Notify the Product Safety Team immediately (Section 8.6).
5. Send a special safety shipping kit by overnight delivery.
    a. The kit follows the lithium battery rules in Section 9.4.1 of the Shipping and Delivery Guide.
    b. The kit is free to the customer regardless of warranty status.
6. If there is smoke or fire,
    a. tell the customer to call emergency services, and
    b. do not ask the customer to move the device.

8.6 Escalation

Table 8.2 — Escalation

Situation	Escalate To
Claim declined and customer disputes	Tier 2
Safety issue or injury	Product Safety Team (immediately)
Repeated failures (3 or more repairs for the same fault)	Technical Services Manager, who may approve a replacement or a refund
Legal threats	Legal and Compliance

Situation	Escalate To
Data privacy concerns	Privacy Office

8.7 Lemon Policy

If the same issue has been repaired three times within the warranty period, or if a product has been out of service for more than 30 days in total, the customer is entitled to a replacement or refund at their choice.

8.7.1 Counting Repairs

- A repair counts when the **same fault** (same symptom and same component area) was fixed and recurred.
- A battery replacement under Section 2.4 counts as one repair, but not if the battery is replaced as part of a recall.
- Repairs for different faults do not combine.

8.7.1.1 What Counts as the Same Fault

8.7.1.1.1 Same Component Area

Faults are the same when they affect the same component group, such as the display assembly, the charging port and board, or the keyboard assembly.

8.7.1.1.1.1 Examples That Combine

Flickering screen, then vertical lines on the same screen: combined as one display fault.

8.7.1.1.1.2 Examples That Do Not Combine

A cracked-screen repair (accidental damage under Care) and a later battery replacement: different components, not combined.

8.7.2 Counting Days Out of Service

Count every calendar day the product was with a Service Center or awaiting parts, from the day the customer sent it to the day it was received back. Days when the customer delayed the repair do not count.

8.7.3 Customer Choice and Amount

The customer chooses between replacement and refund. The refund is the full purchase price with **no** discount for use (Section 5.5.2).

9. Regional Notes

9.1 United States

State laws may give customers rights beyond this warranty, including implied warranties. Nothing in this manual limits those rights.

9.1.1 California

California customers are entitled to repair parts for 7 years for products over $100.

9.1.2 Other States

Where a state requires a longer implied warranty period, the state period applies. Escalate to Legal and Compliance for questions.

9.2 European Union and United Kingdom

Customers have a statutory legal guarantee of at least 2 years for goods that do not conform to the contract. During the first 12 months, the burden is on the seller to show that the product was not defective at delivery. Customers also have a right to repair under local rules.

9.2.1 How This Interacts With the Standard Warranty

- For 12-month products (phones, headphones), the statutory guarantee extends coverage for a total of **2 years** for conformity issues.
- Accidental damage is **not** a conformity issue and is not covered.
- The customer may choose repair or replacement first; if neither is possible, refund.

9.3 Canada, Australia and New Zealand

Statutory consumer guarantees apply to goods that are not of acceptable quality. Customers may be entitled to a repair, replacement, or refund, depending on the severity of the fault.

9.4 Pakistan and Other Regions

Warranty service is provided through authorized service partners. Customers should check the Gadget Grove website for the nearest service center and the local warranty terms.

9.4.1 Advance Replacement Outside the United States

Advance replacement is not available outside the United States (Section 5.2). The customer sends the defective unit to the service partner first.

10. Frequently Asked Questions

10.1 Does opening the device void my warranty?

Yes, if the device was opened by a person who is not an authorized technician, and the damage resulted from it. Self-repair with genuine parts through the Repair Hub does not void the warranty on its own.

10.2 How long will my repair take?

Mail-in repairs normally take 7 to 10 business days from receipt. In-store repairs take 1 to 5 days. On-site appliance repairs depend on technician availability and parts.

10.3 Will I get the same device back?

Repairs are made on the original device. If a replacement is needed, you may receive a new or refurbished device of the same model.

10.4 Do I need the original box?

No. For mail-in repairs, we send a protective box when needed.

10.5 Is the screen cracked? Is that covered?

Not under the standard warranty. It is covered if you have Gadget Grove Care, subject to a deductible.

10.6 Can I ship my device in my own box?

Yes, but we recommend using the prepaid kit. Damage caused by inadequate packaging may not be covered. See Section 5.1.2.

10.7 What happens to my data?

We do not access personal data. Back up and erase your device where possible. Replaced parts and devices are securely erased.

10.8 I bought it on sale. Is the warranty different?

No. The warranty is the same for sale and clearance items, except for items sold as “As Is” or “Refurbished”, which carry a 90-day warranty.

11. Contact Information

Channel	Details
Warranty claims	warranty@gadgetgrove.example
Phone	+1-800-555-0142, Monday to Friday, 9 AM to 6 PM Eastern
Live chat	24/7 in the Gadget Grove app
Service Center	Gadget Grove Service Center, 880 Technology Drive, Austin, TX 78758
Safety issues	safety@gadgetgrove.example

Appendix A. Worked Claim Examples

A.1 Example A: Cracked Screen, Customer Has Care

1. Customer reports a cracked phone screen 8 months after delivery.
2. Standard warranty: not covered (Section 2.3.1).
3. Care: covered as accidental damage. Deductible for a smartphone is $69 (Section 3.1.1.3).
4. Service option: in-store repair, normally 1 to 3 hours (Section 5.3).

A.2 Example B: Battery at 76% at Month 11

1. A smartphone shows 76% maximum capacity at month 11 and 430 cycles.

2. Default rule: below 80% within 12 months and under 500 cycles — covered (Section 2.4.1).
3. A pair of earbuds with 76% at month 11 and 300 cycles is **not** covered because the earbud threshold is 70% (Table 2.3).

A.3 Example C: Repeat Fault and the Lemon Policy

1. A laptop has had its keyboard repaired three times for the same fault within 20 months.
2. Lemon Policy applies (Section 8.7). The customer may choose replacement or a full refund with no discount for use.
3. Escalate to the Technical Services Manager (Section 8.6).

Appendix B. Identifier Formats

Table B.1 — Identifier formats

Identifier	Format	Example	Notes
Claim number	WC-XXXXXXXX (8 digits)	WC-04827135	Issued within minutes of submission
Safety claim tag	SAFETY-BATT	—	Applied by the agent, see Section 8.5
Serial number	Product-specific, 10 to 14 characters	GG4K92LM7T3Q	Printed on the device and the box
Care plan number	CARE-XXXXXXXX	CARE-99120381	Appears on the plan confirmation email
Return merchandise authorization	RMA-XXXXXX	RMA-554201	Included on the prepaid label

Appendix C. Revision History

Table C.1 — Revision history

Version	Date	Change
4.0	October 1, 2026	Added definitions, precedence, battery thresholds by product, Care deductibles, discount for use, lemon counting rules and worked examples
3.4	May 1, 2026	Added dead pixel thresholds
3.2	February 1, 2026	Added advance replacement card hold rules
3.0	July 1, 2025	Introduced Gadget Grove Care